

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS

Index No.:

-----X
JASON SALTERS,

SUMMONS

Plaintiff,

-against-

Plaintiff resides at:
2600 Creston Avenue
Apartment: BB
Bronx, NY 10468

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY
POLICE DEPARTMENT and JOHN AND JANE DOE
POLICE OFFICERS (1-10),

Defendants.
-----X

To the above-named Defendants:

YOU ARE HEREBY SUMMONED to answer the Complaint in this action and to serve a copy of your Answer, or, if the Complaint is not served with this Summons, to serve a notice of appearance on the Plaintiff's attorney within 20 days after service of this Summons or within 30 days after the service is complete if this Summons is not personally delivered to you within the state of New York; and in case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

The basis of the venue designated is the place of incident.

Dated: New York, New York
June 21, 2024

**LAW OFFICE OF
ANDREW C. LAUFER, PLLC**

By: Andrew C. Laufer, Esq.
Attorney for Plaintiff
JASON SALTERS
264 W 40th Street, Suite 604
New York, New York 10018
(212) 422-1020

DEFENDANT'S ADDRESSES

THE CITY OF NEW YORK
100 Church Street, 4th Floor
New York, New York 10007

NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT
c/o CITY OF NEW YORK
100 Church Street, 4th Floor
New York, New York 10007

JOHN AND JANE DOE POLICE OFFICERS (1-10)
c/o CITY OF NEW YORK
100 Church Street, 4th Floor
New York, New York 10007

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS

Index No.:

-----X
JASON SALTERS,

VERIFIED COMPLAINT

Plaintiff,

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY
POLICE DEPARTMENT and JOHN AND JANE DOE
POLICE OFFICERS (1-10),

Defendants.
-----X

Plaintiff, by and through his attorney, Law Office of Andrew C. Laufer, PLLC complaining of the defendants herein, upon information and belief, respectfully show to this Court, and allege as follows:

VENUE

1. Venue is proper in this County because the incident occurred in Kings County.

PRELIMINARY STATEMENT

1. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, the plaintiff was a resident of the County of Bronx, City and State of New York.
2. That at all times hereinafter mentioned defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK was and is a municipal corporation, duly organized and existing under by virtue of the laws of the State of New York.
3. That at all times hereinafter mentioned defendant, NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT was and is a municipal corporation, duly organized and existing under by virtue of the laws of the State of New York.
4. That at all times hereinafter mentioned defendants, JOHN AND JANE DOE POLICE OFFICERS (1-10), were and still are employed with the New York City Police Department.

5. That prior to the institution of this action, a Notice of Claim was duly served upon and filed with the CITY OF NEW YORK on behalf of plaintiff.

6. That at all times herein mentioned, JOHN AND JANE DOE POLICE OFFICERS (1-10), were acting within the scope and course of their employment with the New York Police Department, and under color of State Law.

7. That at all times herein mentioned JOHN AND JANE DOE POLICE OFFICERS (1-10), were acting in their individual and official capacity as employees of defendants THE CITY OF NEW YORK (CITY) and NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT (NYPD).

8. That all the causes of action pleaded herein fall within one or more of the exceptions set forth in New York's Civil Practice Law & Rules 1602 with respect to joint and several liability.

STATEMENT OF FACTS AS TO ALL CAUSES OF ACTION

9. On or about February 5, 2024, between approximately 5:00 a.m. and 11:00 a.m., at the Renaissance Shelter located at 599 Ralph Avenue, Brooklyn, NY 11233, JOHN AND JANE DOE POLICE OFFICERS (1-10) were looking for a resident at the shelter. While acting lawfully during his duty as a Shift Supervisor for NYC Department of Homeless Services ("DHS"), the plaintiff, JASON SALTERS, engaged with and informed the Police Officers of the policies in place that they were not allowed to search or access the dorm arear for the resident but that he and his staff would assist in finding said resident. JOHN AND JANE DOE POLICE OFFICERS (1-10) exited the premises and proceeded to trespass onto the property through a side entrance that was locked. Without justifiable reason, JOHN AND JANE POLICE OFFICERS (1-10), ambushed plaintiff tackling him to the ground and proceeded to assault him by punching and kneeling on his neck and back causing multiple injuries, including but not limited to bruises to the face and limbs, back pain, neck pain, shoulder pain and mental suffering. The plaintiff was

detained by and at the direction of the said individuals as well as other agents, servants and/or employees of the City of New York, including but not limited to, agents employed by the CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT and JOHN AND JANE DOE POLICE OFFICERS (1-10).

10. That the examination of plaintiff (than claimant) was held by defendants on June 20, 2024 pursuant to Municipal Law 50H within ninety (90) days after filing of the aforementioned Notice of Claim.

11. More than thirty (30) days have elapsed since the service of said Notice of Claim upon defendants and defendants have failed, neglected and/or refused to pay, settle, compromise or adjust the claim of the plaintiff herein.

12. This action has been commenced within one year and ninety (90) days after the within cause for action arose including but not limited to any equitable tolling of the statutory time period.

13. That at all times hereinafter defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, was and is a municipal corporation, duly organized and existing under and by virtue of the laws of the State of New York.

14. That at all times hereinafter defendant, THE NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT, was and is a municipal corporation, duly organized and existing under and by virtue of the laws of the State of New York.

15. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, JOHN AND JANE DOE POLICE OFFICERS (1-10) were and still are employed with defendants, THE CITY OF NEW YORK and NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT.

16. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, JOHN AND JANE DOE POLICE OFFICERS (1-10) were acting in their individual and official capacity as an employee of defendants, the CITY OF NEW YORK and NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT.

17. That all the causes of action pleaded herein fall within one or more of the exceptions set forth in New York's Civil Practice Law and Rules 1602 with respect to joint liability.

18. The Defendants, JOHN AND JANE DOE POLICE OFFICERS (1-10), under color of state law, subjected Plaintiff to the foregoing acts and omissions without due process of the law, thereby depriving Plaintiff of his rights, privileges and immunities secured by the Fourth, Fifth, Sixth, and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, including without limitation, deprivation of the following constitutional rights: (a) freedom from unreasonable searches and seizure of his person, including the excessive use of force; (b) freedom from arrest without probable cause; (c) freedom from false imprisonment, meaning wrongful detention without good faith, reasonable suspicion or legal justification of which Plaintiff was aware and did not consent; (d) freedom from the lodging of false and over charges against them by police; (e) freedom from abuse of process and malicious prosecution; and (f) the enjoyment of equal protection, privileges and immunities under the laws.

19. That all the causes of action pleaded herein fall within one or more of the exceptions set forth in New York's Civil Practice Law and Rules 1602 with respect to joint liability.

**FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION FOR VIOLATION OF PLAINTIFF'S CONSTITUTION
RIGHTS UNDER THE FIRST, FOURTH, FIFTH, SIXTH, EIGHTH, FOURTEENTH
AMENDMENTS TO THE UNITED STATES CONSTITUTION, CITY OF NEW YORK
AND NEW YORK STATE LAW PREDICATED UPON FALSE ARREST AND
IMPRISONMENT**

20. Plaintiff repeats and realleges each and every allegation contained above as though set forth at length herein.

21. On or about February 5, 2024, between approximately 5:00 a.m. and 11:00 a.m., at the Renaissance Shelter located at 599 Ralph Avenue, Brooklyn, NY 11233, JOHN AND JANE DOE POLICE OFFICERS (1-10) were looking for a resident at the shelter. While acting lawfully during his duty as a Shift Supervisor for NYC Department of Homeless Services (“DHS”), the plaintiff, JASON SALTERS, engaged with and informed the Police Officers of the policies in place that they were not allowed to search or access the dorm area for the resident but that he and his staff would assist in finding said resident. JOHN AND JANE DOE POLICE OFFICERS (1-10) exited the premises and proceeded to trespass onto the property through a side entrance that was locked. Without justifiable reason, JOHN AND JANE POLICE OFFICERS (1-10), ambushed plaintiff tackling him to the ground and proceeded to assault him by punching and kneeling on his neck and back causing multiple injuries, including but not limited to bruises to the face and limbs, back pain, neck pain, shoulder pain and mental suffering. The plaintiff was then detained by and at the direction of the said individuals as well as other agents, servants and/or employees of the City of New York, including but not limited to, agents employed by the CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT and JOHN AND JANE DOE POLICE OFFICERS (1-10). The plaintiff was wrongfully and falsely arrested, imprisoned and detained without any right or justifiable grounds thereof.

22. That on or about February 5, 2024 defendants, jointly and severally without any warrant, order or other legal process and without legal right, wrongfully and unlawfully arrest plaintiff, restrain him and his liberty.

23. The unlawful conduct of defendants was motivated and instigated by other than lawful reasons and without probable cause.

24. That the said arrest, detention and imprisonment was caused by the CITY, its agents,

servants and employees, including but not limited to the defendant police officers, without a warrant and without any reasonable cause or belief that plaintiff was in fact guilty of any crime.

25. That the CITY, its agents, servants and employees, as set forth above, intended to confine plaintiff; that plaintiff was conscious of the confinement; that plaintiff did not consent to the confinement; and that the confinement was not otherwise privileged.

26. As a result of the aforesaid actions, including the arrest and imprisonment of plaintiff without probable cause, defendants deprived plaintiff of the rights, privileges and immunities secured by the Constitution and Laws of the United States of America and the Fourteenth Amendment.

27. As a result of the aforementioned actions, defendants deprived plaintiff of the right to be free from unreasonable search and seizures secured by the Constitution and Laws of the United States of America and the Fourth, Fourteenth Amendments.

28. As a result of the forementioned actions, defendants deprived plaintiff of his right to liberty without due process of law secured by the Constitution and Laws of the United States of America and the Fourth, Fourteenth Amendments.

29. The aforementioned acts of defendants were intentional, willful and malicious and performed with a reckless disregard for said deliberate indifference to plaintiff's rights.

30. That by reason of the false arrest, imprisonment and detention of plaintiff, plaintiff was subjected to great indignities, humiliation and ridicule in being so detained and was greatly injured in his credit and circumstances and was prevented and hindered from performing and transacting his necessary affairs and was caused to suffer much pain in both mind and body, and to sustain economic loss, and was otherwise damaged.

31. The aforementioned described constitutional violations are all actionable under and

pursuant to 42 U.S.C. Section 1983, 1988 and under New York City and New York State Law.

**SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION FOR VIOLATIONS OF PLAINTIFF'S RIGHTS UNDER
THE FOURTH, FIFTH, SIXTH, EIGHTH, FOURTEENTH AMENDMENTS TO THE
UNITED STATES CONSTITUTION, NEW YORK CITY AND NEW YORK STATE
LAW PREDICATED UPON ASSAULT, BATTERY, AND USE OF EXCESSIVE FORCE
UPON PLAINTIFF**

32. Plaintiff repeats and realleges each and every allegation contained above as though set forth at length herein.

33. That on or about February 5, 2024, between approximately 5:00 a.m. and 11:00 a.m. defendants, THE CITY OF NEW YORK and NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT, its agents, servants, and employees including but not limited to Defendants, JOHN AND JANE DOE POLICE OFFICERS (1-10), jointly and severally in their capacity as police officers, ambushed plaintiff tackling him to the ground, wrongfully handcuffed, and seized the plaintiff about his person, assaulted him by punching and kneeling on his neck and back causing him to sustain physical injuries, including but not limited to bruises to the face and limbs, back pain, neck pain, shoulder pain and mental suffering. At no time did defendants have legal cause to handcuff, seize or touch plaintiff nor did plaintiff consent to this illegal touching nor was privileged by law.

34. All of the acts and omissions by the individual defendants, described above were carried out pursuant to overlapping policies and practices of the CITY which were in existence at the time of the conduct alleged herein and were engaged in with the full knowledge consent and cooperation and under the supervisory authority of defendants CITY and the NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT.

35. Defendants CITY and NYPD, by their policy-making agents, servants and employees, authorized sanctioned and/or ratified the individual defendants' wrongful acts and/or failed to prevent or stop those acts and/or alleged acts from continuing.

36. Defendants arrested and detained plaintiff in the absence of any evidence of criminal wrongdoing notwithstanding their knowledge that said arrest and detention would jeopardize plaintiff's liberty, well-being, safety and constitutional rights.

37. At all times mentioned herein said police officers were acting under color of law, to wit: the statutes, ordinances, regulations, policies and customs and usage of the State of New York and/or City of New York.

38. On or about February 5, 2024, defendants did seize, search and tackle to the ground the person of the plaintiff without a court authorized arrest or search warrant. They did physically seize the person of the plaintiff during the arrest process in an unlawful and excessive manner.

39. The plaintiff was falsely arrested, unlawfully detained and suffered great injury without the defendants processing probable cause to do so.

40. The above actions of defendants resulted in the plaintiff being deprived of the following rights under the United States Constitution.

- a. Freedom from illegal search and seizure
- b. Freedom from arrest
- c. Freedom from unlawful imprisonment.

41. The defendants subjected plaintiff to such deprivations, either in a malicious or reckless disregard of the plaintiff's rights.

42. Defendant CITY has grossly and negligently failed to train and adequately supervise its police officers in the fundamental law of arrest, search and seizure especially when the police

officers are not in possession of a court authorized arrest warrant and where an individual especially as here, has not committed a crime and has not resisted arrest, that its police officers should only use reasonable force to effectuate an arrest and the arrest should be based upon probable cause.

43. The direct proximate results of the defendants' acts are that plaintiff suffered severe and permanent injuries of a psychological and physical nature. He was forced to endure pain and suffering to his detriment.

**THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION FOR NEGLIGENT HIRING, TRAINING, RETENTION
AND SUPERVISION**

44. Plaintiff repeats and realleges each and every allegation contained above as though set forth at length herein.

45. That the aforesaid action and resulting injuries to plaintiff were due to the negligence of the CITY in the hiring, retention and training of its employees, including JOHN AND JANE DOE POLICE OFFICERS (1-10) causing the plaintiff to be falsely arrested and imprisoned, assaulted and battered without justifiable reason or ground thereof and in all ways being grossly negligent and engaging in wanton and reckless conduct.

FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION – MONELL VIOLATIONS

46. Plaintiff repeats and realleges each and every allegation contained above as though set forth at length herein.

47. That plaintiff was deprived of his rights, privileges and immunities secured by the Constitution of the United States of America and the State of New York, and his rights pursuant to 42 USC sec. 1983 by those who under color of a statute or regulation of a state, caused plaintiff to be so deprived.

48. That the aforesaid actions by the defendants, their agents, servants and/or employees were done pursuant to an official municipal policy or custom of the city, which policy involved the deliberate indifference to the health, safety, and welfare of the plaintiff, in failing to properly discipline the defendants and for the purpose of thwarting the fair administration of justice in violation of the 4th and 5th Amendments to the United States Constitution.

49. The above actions of defendants resulted in the plaintiff being deprived of the following rights under the United States Constitution.

- a) Freedom from illegal search and seizure;
- b) Freedom from arrest;
- c) Freedom from malicious prosecution;
- d) Freedom from unlawful imprisonment;
- e) Freedom from the denial of a right to fair trial

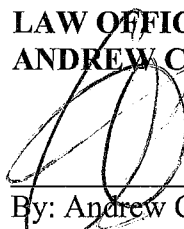
50. The defendants subjected plaintiff to such deprivations, either in a malicious or reckless disregard of the plaintiff's rights.

51. Those defendants herein, their agents, servants and/or employees motivated in part by racial and/or ethnic animus, conspired to deprive plaintiff of his federal civil and constitution rights, in violation of 42 USC 1985.

WHEREFORE, plaintiff demands judgment against defendants, and each of them, on all of the foregoing causes of action, in the form of compensatory damages for plaintiff's pain and suffering, loss of enjoyment of life, and economic loss, in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts that otherwise would have jurisdiction in the matter and plaintiff further demands punitive damages on all causes of action, in an amount to be determined by the trier of fact, together with attorney's fees and together with costs and disbursements.

DATED: New York, New York
June 21, 2024

**LAW OFFICE OF
ANDREW C. LAUFER, PLLC**



By: Andrew C. Laufer, Esq.,
Attorney for Plaintiff

JASON SALTERS
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New York, New York 10018
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SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS

Index No.:

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JASON SALTERS,

VERIFICATION

Plaintiffs,

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY
POLICE DEPARTMENT and JOHN AND JANE DOE
POLICE OFFICERS (1-10),

Defendants.

-----X

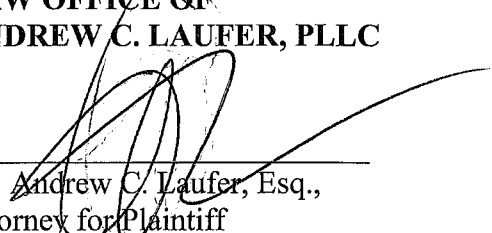
ANDREW C. LAUFER, an attorney duly admitted to practice law in the Courts of New York, affirms the following to be true:

1. That I am the principal of the Law Office of Andrew C. Laufer, PLLC, attorney for the plaintiff in the within action. That I have read the foregoing complaint and know the contents thereof, and that the same are true to my knowledge, except as to the matters herein stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and that as to these matters I believe them to be true.
2. That the sources of my information and knowledge are records and investigation reports maintained within the file.
3. That the reason this verification is made by the affirmant and not by the plaintiff is that the plaintiff does not reside in the County of New York, which is the county wherein this firm maintains its office.

Dated: New York, New York
June 21, 2024

[signature on following page]

**LAW OFFICE OF
ANDREW C. LAUFER, PLLC**



By: Andrew C. Laufer, Esq.,
Attorney for Plaintiff

JASON SALTERS
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